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The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, little wind, high 54. **Tonight**, clear, cool, little wind, low 41. **Tomorrow**, sun and clouds, warmer than the past few days, light wind, high 65. Weather map, Page B8.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

Cease-Fire Shaky as Attacks Are Exchanged in Mideast



The aftermath of Israeli airstrikes on Wednesday in Beirut, Lebanon. Iran also persisted in its strikes against Persian Gulf neighbors.

Confusion Over Status of Strait — Israel Bombards Lebanon

This article is by **Adam Rasgon, Yeganeh Torbati, Euan Ward and Michael Levenson.**

A tenuous cease-fire between the United States and Iran was being tested on Wednesday by heavy Israeli bombardment in Lebanon, which Israel and President Trump insisted was not part of the cease-fire deal, and by continued Iranian attacks on its Persian Gulf neighbors.

Although the cease-fire promised to bring two weeks of relative calm to the Middle East and buy time for Iran and the United States to hammer out a longer-term peace deal, many questions remained about the fate of Iran's highly enriched uranium, the safe passage of ships in the Strait of Hormuz and whether ongoing Iranian and Israeli attacks could upend the diplomatic process.

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif of Pakistan, who helped broker the cease-fire that was announced on Tuesday, wrote on social media on Wednesday that violations had been reported in several places, “which undermine the spirit” of the peace process.

“I earnestly and sincerely urge all parties to exercise restraint and respect the ceasefire for two

weeks, as agreed upon, so that diplomacy can take a lead role towards peaceful settlement of the conflict,” he wrote.

Talks aimed at a long-term agreement were set to begin on Saturday in Islamabad, Pakistan's capital. Iran's Supreme National Security Council confirmed that Iranian leaders would take part in the negotiations. The Trump administration said it would send Vice President JD Vance; Steve Witkoff, a special envoy; and Jared Kushner, Mr. Trump's son-in-law.

Continued on Page A9



ARASH KHAMOUSHI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Getting Oil Flowing Again Isn’t as Simple as Reopening the Strait

By **REBECCA F. ELLIOTT and IVAN PENN**

HOUSTON — Reopening the Strait of Hormuz — a central aim for the United States when it agreed to a cease-fire with Iran — would be the first step toward getting more energy flowing through the Persian Gulf.

But only the first step.

That is because dozens of refineries, storage facilities, and oil and gas fields in at least nine countries, from Iran to the United Arab Emirates and beyond, have been targeted in strikes. All told, 10 percent or more of the world's oil sup-

ply has been turned off. Restarting those operations will require not only safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz, but also inspecting pumps, replacing bespoke processing equipment and recalling employees and ships that have scattered across the globe.

“It's not a case of you just flick a switch and everything's back up again,” said Martin Houston, a longtime oil and gas executive who now serves as board member for several energy companies.

The timeline for bringing the Gulf energy system back to some semblance of normal is highly uncertain. For one thing, the war has

Fixing Equipment and Recalling Workers Will Take Time

been formally paused for only two weeks. And the cease-fire appeared to be on shaky ground with attacks continuing across the region on Wednesday.

Under the deal that President Trump announced Tuesday evening, Iran agreed to allow ships to pass through the strait without being attacked, but there was no sign on Wednesday that

vessels were returning to the waterway in large numbers. Earlier that day, Mr. Trump said that if the waterway remained closed, “a whole civilization will die tonight, never to be brought back again.” He has also repeatedly threatened to strike Iranian power plants and other critical infrastructure if Iran does not allow vessels to pass through the strait — acts that could be considered war crimes.

Attacks on energy facilities continued in the days leading up to the cease-fire, including on an oil refinery in Kuwait and petrochemical complexes in Iran. How much damage has already been

Continued on Page A8

Even Supporters of War Ask: What Goals Did U.S. Achieve?

By **ANTON TROIANOVSKI**

WASHINGTON — President Trump went to war on Feb. 28 pledging to prevent Iran from getting a nuclear weapon, destroy its missile capability, break its regional proxies, eliminate its navy and create an opening for regime change.

After five weeks of bombardment, Mr. Trump agreed to a cease-fire with none of those goals clearly accomplished.

In his social media post on Tuesday announcing the end of U.S. bombing, for now, if Iran reopens the Strait of Hormuz, Mr. Trump said that “we have already met and exceeded all Military objectives.” Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth told reporters on Wednesday that the United States had achieved a “historic and overwhelming victory” because Iran's military had been rendered “combat ineffective for years to come.”

Still, even supporters of the president's decision to go to war voiced doubts that Iran had in fact been defeated. Mark Levin, the Fox News host whom Mr. Trump often praises, lamented in prime time on Tuesday night that the Iranian regime was “still surviving.” Laura Loomer, the far-right activist close to the White House, posted online that “we didn't really get anything out of” the cease-fire talks “and the terrorists in Iran are celebrating.” Lindsey Graham, the hawkish Republican senator from South Carolina, warned that Congress would need to review any deal.

The hand-wringing from the president's staunchest backers highlighted the disconnect between the vast firepower of the U.S. military on display over the last month and the war's more

Continued on Page A9

A Guilty Plea Abruptly Closes The Gilgo Case

This article is by **Corey Kilgannon, Nate Schweber and Thomas Fuller.**

RIVERHEAD, N.Y. — They were some of New York's most gruesome unsolved crimes, the bodies of women that kept turning up not far from the beaches where millions of people flock every summer.

On Wednesday, the case came to an abrupt end as Rex Heuer-mann, 62, pleaded guilty almost three years after his arrest. The man who lived a double life for years, as a briefcase-toting architectural consultant in Manhattan and a serial killer based out of his middle-class neighborhood on Long Island, admitted to a judge he had murdered seven women, and an eighth he had not previously been charged with killing.

Mr. Heuermann was arrested in 2023 after a police investigation that spanned more a decade and that was marred by dysfunction. The case was ultimately solved with the help of cellular phone data and DNA evidence gathered from pizza crust, bottles and human hairs that linked Mr. Heuermann to the crime.

Scheduled to go to trial in the fall, the case ended in a packed Suffolk County courtroom on Wednesday with Mr. Heuermann's plea. He agreed to life sentences in prison.

Continued on Page A20

Lack of Snowpack Spells Dry Summer for West

This article is by **Scott Dance, Sachi Kitajima Mulkey and Mira Rojanasakul.**

After the warmest winter on record for many states and a blistering March heat wave that left almost no snow in parts of the American West, the region is facing a summer of serious wildfire risks and a drought that could force broad water restrictions.

New measurements this month show that most of the Mountain West won't be able to rely on melting snow, the region's largest water source, because there's hardly any snowpack. And while some rain is forecast in the coming weeks, any spring precipitation will likely be too little, too late, scientists said.

“It's going to be a seriously dry summer ahead,” said Nels Bjarke, a research scientist with the Western Water Assessment at the University of Colorado, Boulder.

Scientists in many parts of the West found a snow drought this month unlike any they had seen. Almost the whole region was affected, rather than just isolated pockets, said Noah Molotch, a professor of hydrology at the University of Colorado, Boulder.

At one key snowpack measurement site in California's Sierra Nevada, scientists last week found only traces of snow. In parts of western Colorado, mountain slopes where researchers have always measured at least 6 inches of snowpack at this time of year were virtually snowless. Across

Continued on Page A14



A heat wave in March compounded the effect of a record-warm winter in which precipitation often fell as rain rather than snow.

RISKY PASSAGE A few vessels have crossed the Strait of Hormuz since the U.S.-Iran truce began, but most ships remain wary. **PAGE B1**

CEASE-FIRE ANXIETY Hours after a pause to a nearly six-week war, Iranians expressed relief, but trepidation about the future. **PAGE A10**

Trump, to Raise Military Budget, Targets Policies to Help at Home

By **TONY ROMM and ANNIE KARNI**

WASHINGTON — For decades, the U.S. government has helped poor Americans pay their home heating and cooling bills. It sends money to states, which then administer the aid, assisting nearly six million households nationally.

With a roughly \$4 billion budget, the bipartisan program known as LIHEAP is just a sliver of a sprawling federal balance sheet that ranges well into the trillions each year. Yet it counts among the vast set of federal aid that President Trump is trying to eliminate, as he scrounges for ways to cut costs at home and fund a larger, more expensive military.

Mr. Trump has eyed a series of potentially unpopular and divisive domestic spending cuts for the next fiscal year, in a move that

may test the political appetite and financial health of a cost-weary American public. Even as voters grow frustrated with the economy — and seem eager to exact their vengeance at the ballot box — the president has proposed to scale back some of the very federal programs that are meant to ease families' toughest financial burdens.

By the president's own reasoning, the U.S. government cannot afford the expense. At a private lunch last week, Mr. Trump insisted Washington needed to prioritize “military protection” above all else, especially with the United States still at war with Iran. Otherwise, he said in a since-deleted video, the country could not continue to shoulder the financial bur-

Continued on Page A17

NATIONAL A11-17, 20

Deaths Followed a Budget Cut
Idaho scrambled to reverse reductions in outreach to people with mental illness after a series of bad outcomes. **PAGE A11**

Lithium Trove in California
Imperial County residents are in dire need of an economic lift. The answer may lie under the Salton Sea. **PAGE A12**



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Aftermath of a Strike on Kabul
As families mourned those lost at a drug rehab center last month, Pakistan maintained it had hit military targets. **PAGE A6**

Roma May Sway Hungary Vote
Prime Minister Viktor Orban doled out jobs to a marginalized minority, but also may have kept it an underclass. **PAGE A7**

OBITUARIES B11-12

Guru of Avant-Garde Fashion
Linda Dresner's minimalist store was a destination for generations of moneyed New Yorkers and helped change the way clothing was sold. She was 88. **PAGE B12**

BUSINESS B1-5

‘I Got Back Every Penny’
The law Republicans passed last year has so far been largely imperceptible to most Americans. That's changing as they file their taxes this spring. **PAGE B1**

SPORTS B6-10

How McIlroy Conjured Magic
With the Masters set to begin, last year's champion recalled the five best shots in his roller-coaster victory. **PAGE B6**

A Less-Than-Grand Finale
Michigan was a virtuosic champion, but the N.C.A.A. men's basketball tournament wasn't a masterpiece. **PAGE B7**

ARTS C1-6

Unconventional Perspectives
New galleries at the Los Angeles County Museum of Arts will offer a novel approach to art history. **PAGE C1**

Broadway's ‘Jellicle Ball’
The cats strut in a reappraisal of Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical. Below, Chasity Moore is cast as Grizabella. **PAGE C1**



THURSDAY STYLES D1-8

The Celebrity Journalist
Patrick Radden Keefe, “a storyteller of the highest order,” is one of the last household names in nonfiction. **PAGE D6**

Turmoil at Bard College
The Hudson Valley institution is split over its president, Leon Botstein, and his close ties to Jeffrey Epstein. **PAGE D1**

OPINION A18-19

Thomas L. Friedman **PAGE A18**

